Day 61 (stop 2 of 3) - Nels Maher, Tumbled Rocks, Edmonstone, Dodds Hill

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 79 · Kemble Mountain & Dodd's Hill, Georgian Bluffs

6.6 km / 4.1 mi	~2.1 h	2.4 km new	173 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Parking for several cars on Kemble Rock Rd at the Nels Maher Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day61b_hike079.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Nels Maher Side Trail (1.1 km); Tumbled Rocks Side Trail (0.8 km); Edmonstone Side Trail (0.4 km); Dodds Hill Side Trail (0.1 km)

Same day: this is stop 2 of 3 on day 61 (7.8 mi of hiking, about 378 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 78, 2.7 mi from Roadside parking on Lundy Lane; stop 3: hike 80, 0.9 mi from Bruce's Caves Conservation Area.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** There is room for several cars on Kemble Rock Rd at the Nels Maher Side Trail.
- **Kemble Mountain:** A trip report describes the main trail after Kemble Rock Rd running along a wide dolostone outcrop on top of the Escarpment, then through shady forest with dense Canadian wild ginger, ferns and mushrooms. It's a good choice for a hot day.
- **Dodd's Hill:** The Sydenham club says the stretch from Kemble Mountain to Dodd's Hill is "filled with fissures" and full of ferns. Watch your footing and keep Zappy on a short leash near the cracks in the rock.
- **Edmonstone and Nels Maher side trails:** Together with the main trail they form a loop of about 3 km through mixed hardwood forest, according to Ontario Nature Trails. The short Dodds Hill Side Trail is a quick spur off the main trail.
- **Dogs:** Zappy stays on leash. The Sydenham club asks that dogs be leashed and kept under control, especially near farmland, and suggests an orange or fluorescent harness or bandana in hunting season so a dog isn't mistaken for wildlife.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking on Concession 24 at the Dodd's Hill Side Trail map	Free	2.5	110 m	Dodds Hill, Tumbled Rocks

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 2.2 km / 1.4 mi, covering Nels Maher. **Outing 2** from P2 (Roadside parking on Concession 24 at the Dodd's Hill Side Trail; Free): 5.0 km / 3.1 mi, covering Dodds Hill, Edmonstone, Tumbled Rocks. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Parking for several cars on Kemble Rock Rd at the Nels Maher Side Trail. Head north-east on the blue-blazed Edmonstone Side Trail.
0.4	0.2	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)

1.5	0.9	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Tumbled Rocks Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.3	1.4	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Dodds Hill Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.4	1.5	J4: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.6	1.6	J3: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Tumbled Rocks Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
3.2	2.0	J2: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Tumbled Rocks Side Trail you already walked goes off behind you.)
4.3	2.7	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Edmonstone Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
4.7	2.9	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Nels Maher Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.9	3.1	J6: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Nels Maher Side Trail, heading south-west.
5.8	3.6	J7: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
6.6	4.1	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club, Ontario Nature Trails and a Holmstrom Ruddick trip report.